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Research Statement

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I am a researcher working in macro-finance and banking. I study how banks and firms interact in the market for credit: what determines loan pricing, how credit is allocated across firms, and how monetary policy affects equilibrium outcomes. My investigation starts from an empirical fact: observationally equivalent firms in terms of credit quality do not pay the same rates for similar loans; my research shows that this is true when firms borrow from different banks, or even when they borrow from the same bank. Understanding these rate differentials matters because they have implications for regulation and monetary-policy transmission, as well as for firms' investment and growth.

The question that organizes my work is how much of the price a firm pays reflects what its lender knows about the true credit quality of the firm, and how much reflects how little competition that bank faces. The question is hard because the two forces are not independent. A bank prices on what it learns only to the extent that rivals cannot undercut it, and it pays to learn only when the rents from screening survive competition. Information and competition therefore jointly determine the rate a firm is quoted, which firms are offered credit at all, how the surplus from a lending relationship is divided, and how monetary policy passes through to firms. Studying either force in isolation misreads all four outcomes. In my work, I address this question from several perspectives, relying on French administrative micro-data on lending, and equilibrium models of loan pricing under search frictions and asymmetric information.

Default risk surprises and banks' loan pricing. In my job market paper, I rationalize interest rate differentials across observationally equivalent firms by combining empirical evidence and a structural model. I show that jointly considering what banks know about borrowers' credit quality and the degree of competition among banks is key to understanding the observed rate dispersion. I am honored that this paper has been awarded the **2026 Lamfalussy Fellowship by the European Central Bank**.

I start by documenting new empirical facts: interest rate differentials across similar firms borrowing similar loan products from the same bank contain information on future changes in firms' default risk. I use public rating data from Banque de France, a sufficient statistic for creditworthiness, to map rating classes to default probabilities and to track the evolution of firms' default probability after loan issuance. Using about one million French loans matched to Banque de France ratings, I find that interest rate differentials contain information on future revisions of default probability: a firm whose probability of default increases by 1 percentage point after one year paid, on average, 0.04 percentage points more at issuance; the premium doubles for young and small firms, is larger at long maturities, and peaks in 2009–2012. Comparing fixed- and variable-rate borrowers when reference rates rose rules out the reverse channel: a more expensive loan does not lead to the firm's rating deterioration. This is suggestive evidence that banks know more than the econometrician. But information cannot be the whole story: banks operate in an imperfectly competitive market. To tease out the forces at play in the data, I develop a model of loan pricing that combines search frictions, which generate imperfect competition between banks, with asymmetric information: banks see only an imperfect public signal of firms' risk types. The model adds asymmetric information to the price-dispersion tradition of Varian (1980) and Burdett and Judd (1983), and is closest to Lester et al. (2019),

who screen privately informed borrowers in a frictional market with menus of contracts, while I let banks sort borrowers with the rate alone, the instrument I observe in the data. The signal allows banks to sort borrowers, while search limits firms' ability to arbitrage away differences in borrowing costs. In equilibrium, the positive rate-risk relationship can arise either when the signal is sufficiently precise to separate borrowers, or, even without information, from search frictions that lead banks to randomize between pooling borrowers and inducing self-selection through pricing. By calibrating the model to the data, I show that both information and search are necessary to account for the empirical patterns. I find that, in safer markets, banks are informed and separate borrowers; in riskier ones, they are uninformed and pool borrowers. This suggests that the riskiness of the worst rating classes is already well summarized by the rating.

Expanding the analysis to the euro area. An important direction of my research agenda is to overcome the data limitations of my job market paper by seeking access to the euro area central bank loan-level registry, AnaCredit. My current measure of bank information relies on public ratings, and it has a clear bias: I observe a realized outcome, which may differ from the ex-ante banks' expectation on which firms deteriorate; assuming that the bank is right on average, but , so the approach *understates* how much rates reflect what banks know at issuance. Observing banks' own internal ratings would close that gap. This also raises a question worth asking in its own right: are internal ratings accurate in measuring expected default risk, or do they respond to other needs related to capital requirements and regulation? I plan to test how precisely internal ratings assigned at issuance predict realized default. AnaCredit provides the natural setting to explore this question: it records internal ratings alongside loan terms, the full bank–firm exposure history and default outcomes, none of which survey data provide. In addition, the registry covers banks and firms across the euro area, allowing me to study cross-country differences in monetary-policy pass-through and assess their implications for policy. My model provides a framework to interpret these differences through country-specific parameters governing signal precision and the degree of competition.

When lenders disagree. In ongoing work with Gaetano Gaballo (HEC Paris), I am expanding the theoretical framework of my job market paper to understand endogenous information acquisition under asymmetric information and imperfect competition. My job market paper assumes that all banks observe the same signal about a firm upon matching, so asymmetric information runs between banks and firms, and between the econometrician and banks. Here, instead, each bank independently screens, drawing a signal that is independent of its rival's given the firm's type, as in Broecker (1990), and choosing how precise that signal is. Two banks competing for the same firm can then disagree about its quality, so the signal-specific rate distributions cannot be solved one at a time: a bank that drew a good signal may be bidding against a rival that drew a bad one, and each signal's rate distribution therefore depends on the other's. This possibility is ruled out when the signal is common, since banks always agree and each signal is its own market. We solve the joint equilibrium in closed form. The two signals sort across the rate range: banks that drew a good signal post the lowest rates in the market, banks that drew a bad signal the highest. Banks may post in the pooling region only, or separate when banks observing a bad signal post high rates that only risky firms accept; the outcome is summarized by one index of the degree of adverse selection. Our main result concerns the value of precision. Wherever the two signal groups still share at least one rate, a bank can stop screening, post that rate after either signal and earn exactly what an informed bank earns, because imperfect competition has already equalized the two signals' profits there; in this case, the private return to precision is zero. Therefore, assuming a positive and increasing cost of information, only two kinds of market survive: markets in which banks prefer to remain uninformed, and markets in which the two rate ranges are disjoint. This sharpens Hauswald and Marquez (2003, 2006), who find that competition erodes the return to screening, into the statement that no interior precision is an equilibrium, and it explains why the calibration in my job market paper places

banks at the two corners, informed in the safe rating classes and uninformed in the risky ones. It also identifies what restores an interior optimum: screening has to lower the cost of lending, as monitoring does, rather than only re-sort borrowers.

Taken together, my research studies how information and competition shape the pricing and allocation of credit. Across banks, I aim to understand how lenders' private information, market power, and strategic choices generate differences in loan pricing, credit access, and monetary-policy transmission. Going forward, I aim to combine richer loan-level data with equilibrium models of information acquisition and competition. This agenda will allow me to study how changes in information sharing, market structure, and lender organization affect credit markets, and ultimately to distinguish when credit-market dispersion reflects valuable information and when it reflects market power.

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